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1. Research Question

This research note examines the composition of the Democratic Republic of the Congo men's national-team player pool across two call-up windows in September and October 2026.

The analysis asks:

- Who was included in the two call-up groups?
- How much overlap existed between the groups?
- What positions were represented?
- Where were the players' clubs located?

2. Data Sources

Player and national-team call-up information was compiled primarily from Fédération Congolaise de Football-Association (FECOFA) announcements.

Additionally, FBref was used as a secondary football-data source for player information when available and 365scores was also used for selected player information when FBref did not provide a record.

Finally, match-event information, including substitutions, goals, and assists, was obtained from ESPN where appropriate.

Each player was assigned a unique ***player_id***, while each national-team call-up window received a separate ***callup_id***. Source URLs and verification dates were recorded to support data provenance.

3. Dataset

The current pilot dataset contains 39 unique players across two national-team call-up windows. The first call-up window covered September 21–29, 2026, while the second covered September 28–October 6, 2026.

The dataset also contains national-team match and player-appearance information for the initial matches analyzed.

Dataset	Records
Unique players	39
Call-up events	2
Matches analyzed	2
Player-appearance records	31

4. Findings

   4.1 Call-up composition

   The first call-up contained twenty-nine (29) players, while the second contained twenty-four (24) players. Sixteen (16) players appeared across both call-up windows, while ten (10) players were newly included in the second window.

   4.2 Positional distribution

   Defenders represented the largest positional group in the combined call-up records, followed by midfielders. Goalkeepers represented the smallest group.

   4.3 Club geography

   The players represented clubs across 19 countries and 4 continents. Europe accounted for 80% of the club locations represented in the dataset, while North America accounted for 3.63%.

   4.4 Match participation

   The first two matches analyzed provide an initial view of player participation at national-team level. The appearance dataset records who started the games, how many minutes each footballer played, who were substituted on and off, how many goals each player who played during the games scored, and how many assists the players each had.

   Eighteen (18) players appeared across the two matches, with thirteen (13) players starting at least one match.

5. Limitations

   This analysis represents a small pilot dataset rather than a complete census of Congolese professional footballers. Player information is dependent on the availability and coverage of the sources consulted.

FBref notes that its player records may be incomplete for players who have moved through leagues outside its coverage. Some information therefore required secondary sources.
In addition, the match sample currently covers only two matches and should not be interpreted as a comprehensive measure of national-team performance.

6. Next Steps
   The next phase of the project will build a player's profile analysis and investigate the club environments of Congolese national-team players, including club competition level and playing-time availability if feasible.
   The broader objective is to develop a global, source-documented understanding of Congolese football players and their career pathways.